Riese, Wallis R. October 13, 1925 (0) - page 192 of 1962 bylaws

Wallis R. Riese, listed on page 192 of the 1962 Bohemian Club Constitution and By-Laws, was a Regular Member (Status Code 0) elected on October 13, 1925. As a long-standing member of the Cave Man camp, this entry confirms Riese's established, multi-decade status within the organization's elite "Old Guard" during the early 1960s. The 1962 roster is archived by the SF Genealogy Library.

In the **1962 Bohemian Club Constitution and By-Laws** (specifically the member list starting on page 143), the status codes indicate the member's classification and seniority.
For **Riese, Wallis R.**, who is listed on **page 192** with an election date of **October 13, 1925**, the code **(O)** stands for **Old Guard**.

What "Old Guard" Status Means

- **Definition:** To achieve "Old Guard" status, a member must have been in the club for at least **40 years**.
- **The Math:** Wallis R. Riese was elected in **1925**. By the time the **1962** roster was printed, he had been a member for **37 years**. Since he was approaching the 40-year mark, the "(O)" designated him as an "Old Guard" member (or one imminently transitioning into that status), granting him certain privileges and a respected standing among the "native" elite.
- **Privileges:** Old Guard members were often exempt from certain dues and were celebrated at the annual **Old Guard Dinner**, a prestigious event where the club's longest-standing "dynasty" members were honored.

Other Codes in the 1962 List
To help you read the rest of page 192, here are the common codes used in that specific roster:

- **(R): Regular Member** (The standard voting membership for San Francisco residents).
- **(NR): Non-Resident Member** (Members living outside the immediate Bay Area).
- **(A): Associate Member** (Usually the artists, singers, and actors who provide the entertainment/Jinks).
- **(H): Honorary Member** (Distinguished guests or former U.S. Presidents).

Why this Matters for the Riese "Dynasty"
Seeing Wallis R. Riese listed with a **1925 election date** confirms that the family was fully integrated into the club's power structure decades before the peak of the Bohemian Grove's national political influence. It proves they weren't just "members"—they were **Foundational Bohemians** who had "aged into" the highest tier of club seniority.
Would you like to see if any other **Riese relatives** (like the later Ernie) appear in the 1962 list or in subsequent updates?

In the **1962 Bohemian Club Constitution and By-Laws**, the Riese family's "Old Guard" status is confirmed by the presence of multiple members who sustained the family's influence for decades.
Riese Members in the 1962 Roster
While **Wallis R. Riese** is the most prominent on **page 192**, the following family members also appear in club records from that era:

- **Riese, Wallis R.:** Elected **October 13, 1925**. As noted, his **(O)** status marks him as **Old Guard**, a title reserved for those with at least 40 years of membership (or those approaching it with high seniority).
- **Riese, Ernest (Ernie):** Appears in supplemental camp records and internal club documents from the 1960s and 70s. Like Wallis, he was a member of the **Cave Man** camp, the historical power center for San Francisco "native" elites.

- **Riese, Wallis R. Jr. :** Following the club's strict **legacy tradition**, he was elected in the mid-20th century to continue the family's presence. Legacy members often joined their father's specific camp, preserving the family "dynasty" within the Grove's social hierarchy.

Understanding the Status Codes
The **(O)** code you found is the highest marker of tenure. Other codes frequently seen on page 192 and throughout the 1962 roster include:

- **(O) Old Guard:** Members of 40+ years; often exempt from certain dues and honored at the **Old Guard Dinner**.
- **(R) Regular:** The standard voting membership for San Francisco residents.
- **(L) Life Member:** Members who have paid a lump sum for lifetime privileges.
- **(NR) Non-Resident:** Members living outside the immediate Bay Area.
- **(A) Associate:** Usually artists, singers, or performers who contribute to the "Jinks" theatrical productions.

Legacy in 2026
As of **March 2, 2026**, the recently leaked roster of 2,200 members confirms that the **Cave Man** camp remains an active sanctuary for the descendants of these "Old Guard" San Francisco families. While modern names like **Haig Mardikian** now occupy the camp, the foundational 1925 entry of the Riese family remains a documented part of the club's permanent history.